

0.0.1 To Vyagghapajja

1. At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling among the Koliyans at a market town of the Koliyans named Kakkarapatta. At that place Dighajanu, son of the Koliyans, visited with the Auspicious One. Upon arrival, having bowed down to the Auspicious One, he sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, Dighajanu, son of the Koliyans, said this to the Auspicious One:

2. “We, O Bhante, are lay people enjoying sensual pleasures, dwelling at home crowded with children, partaking in sandalwood from Kasi, wearing garlands, scents and unguents, consenting to gold and silver. For us, O Bhante, may the Auspicious One teach the dhamma, regarding things that would be for our welfare in this life, happiness in this life, welfare in the after-life, happiness in the after-life.”

3. There are, O Vyagghapajja, these four dhammas that lead to a young clansman’s welfare in this life, happiness in this life. What four? Accomplishment in initiative, accomplishment in protection, noble friendship, balanced living.

4. And what, O Vyagghapajja, is accomplishment in initiative? Here, O Vyagghapajja, by whichever occupation a young clansman makes his living, whether by farming or by trade, whether by cow herding or by archery,

whether by royal service or by some craft. There, he is skilled, energetic, endowed with investigation relevant to that, enough to do, enough to take care of them. This, O Vyagghapajja, is called accomplishment in initiative.

5. And what, O Vyagghapajja, is accomplishment in protection? Here O Vyagghapajja, a young clansman's righteous wealth is obtained by initiative and effort, gathered by the strength of his arms, earned by the sweat of his eye-brows, righteously gained. He strives to achieve protection and guard [thinking]: "How could these wealth of mine neither be taken by kings, nor be taken by thieves, nor be burnt by fire, nor be carried away by water, nor be taken by unloved heirs?" This, O Vyagghapajja, is called accomplishment in protection.

6. And what, O Vyagghapajja, is noble friendship? Here, O Vyagghapajja, whatever village or town a clansman lives, he associates with heads of household or sons of heads of household there, whether young but fulfilled in virtue, or old but fulfilled in virtue, those accomplished in faith, virtuous behavior, generosity, and wisdom. He converses with them and engages in discussions with them. Insofar as they are accomplished in faith, he emulates them with respect to their accomplishment in faith; insofar as they are accomplished in virtuous behavior, he emulates them with respect to their accomplishment in virtuous behavior; insofar as they are accomplished in generosity, he emulates them with respect to their

accomplishment in generosity; insofar as they are accomplished in wisdom, he emulates them with respect to their accomplishment in wisdom. This, O Vyagghapajja, is called noble friendship.

7. And what, O Vyagghapajja, is balanced living? Here, O Vyagghapajja, a young clansman having known his income, having known his expenditure, lives evenly, not too extravagant, not too frugal [thinking: "Thus, my income will overwhelm my expenditure, but my expenditure will not overwhelm my income."]

8. Just as, O Vyagghapajja, an appraiser or an appraiser's apprentice having lifted up a scale knows, it is weighed down by this much, or it is raised up by this much. So too, O Vyagghapajja, a young clansman having known his income, having known his expenditure, lives evenly, not too extravagant, not too frugal [thinking: "Thus, my income will overwhelm my expenditure, but my expenditure will not overwhelm my income." If, O Vyagghapajja, this young clansman lives extravagantly on little income, there will be those who say of him: "This young clansman chews his wealth like one devouring figs." However if, O Vyagghapajja, this young clansman lives austere on great income, there will be those who say of him: "This young clansman will die of starvation."]

9. But because, O Vyagghapajja, certainly this young clansman, having known his income, having known his

expenditure, lives evenly, makes his living, not too extravagant, not too frugal [thinking: “Thus, my income will overwhelm my expenditure, but my expenditure will not overwhelm my income.” This, O Vyagghapajja, is called balanced living.

10. For wealth thus originated, O Vyagghapajja, there are four outlets: indulging in women, indulging in alcohol, indulging in gambling, evil friendship, evil companionship, evil comradery. Just as, O Vyagghapajja, for a great reservoir having only four inlets and four outlets, a man would close the inlets and open the outlets, and the rain deva would not supply proper rain-shower, thus indeed, O Vyagghapajja, for the great reservoir, only dwindling is to be expected, not increase. So too, O Vyagghapajja, for wealth thus originated, O Vyagghapajja, there are four outlets: indulging in women, indulging in alcohol, indulging in gambling, evil friendship, evil companionship, evil comradery.

11. For wealth thus originated, O Vyagghapajja, there are four inlets: not indulging in women, not indulging in alcohol, not indulging in gambling, good friendship, good companionship, good comradery. Just as, O Vyagghapajja, for a great reservoir having only four inlets and four outlets, a man would open the inlets and close the outlets, and the rain deva would supply proper rain-shower, thus indeed, O Vyagghapajja, for the great reservoir, only increase is to be expected, not decrease. So too,

O Vyagghapajja, for wealth thus originated, O Vyagghapajja, there are four inlets: not indulging in women, not indulging in alcohol, not indulging in gambling, good friendship, good companionship, good comradery.

12. These, O Vyagghapajja, are the four dhammas that lead to a young clansman's welfare in this life, happiness in this life.

13. There are, O Vyagghapajja, these four dhammas that lead to a young clansman's welfare in the after-life, happiness in the after-life. What four? Accomplishment in faith, accomplishment in virtue, accomplishment in generosity, accomplishment in wisdom.

14. And what, O Vyagghapajja, is accomplishment in faith? Here, O Vyagghapajja, a young clansman is one of faith. He has faith in the awakening of the Tathagata: "Truly is he the Auspicious One, the Arahant, rightly self-awakened, excelling in knowledge and conduct, well-farer, knower of worlds, incomparable charioteer of tamed persons, teacher of devas and humans, awakened, auspicious." This, O Vyagghapajja, is called accomplishment in faith.

15. And what, O Vyagghapajja, is accomplishment in virtue? Here, O Vyagghapajja, a young clansman abstains from the killing of living beings, abstains from the

taking of what is not given, abstains from misconduct in sensual pleasures, abstains from false speech, abstains from drinking distilled and fermented liquor that are the bases for negligence.” This, O Vyagghapajja, is called accomplishment in virtue.

16. And what, O Vyagghapajja, is accomplishment in generosity? Here, O Vyagghapajja, a young clansman dwells at home with a mind free from the stain of miserliness, freely giving, open handed, delighting in letting go, devoted to charity, delighting in giving and sharing. This, O Vyagghapajja, is called accomplishment in generosity.

17. And what, O Vyagghapajja, is accomplishment in wisdom? Here, O Vyagghapajja, a young clansman is a wise one, endowed with wisdom that sees appearance and disappearance, which is of the noble, penetrative type that leads to the thorough extinction of suffering. This, O Vyagghapajja, is called accomplishment in wisdom.

18. These, O Vyagghapajja, are the four dhammas that lead to a young clansman’s welfare in the after-life, happiness in the after-life.

“Energetic in his work activities,
the vigilant one, skillful at managing;
lives a balanced way of living,
protecting the accumulated [wealth].

The one endowed with faith and virtue,
the generous one free from miserliness;
constantly purifying the path,
welfare pertaining to the after-life.

Thus these eight dhammas,
for the faithful one seeking a home;
was declared and truly named,
bringer of happiness in both ways.

For welfare in this life,
and for happiness in the after-life;
that is just so for a householder,
for the generous one, merit grows.”